

A PLACE THAT NURTURES EMPLOYEES' POTENTIAL

At Amazon India, the core belief has always been this: merit and diversity can walk hand-in-hand

BY ARNAB DUTTA

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IN 2011, WHEN Deepti Varma started her journey with Amazon India, it was a time when the American giant was yet to etch its name firmly in the Indian market. Despite her senior role at a private healthcare firm, Varma was drawn to Amazon by the company's values, particularly its ethos of empowering innovation regardless of geography. Reflecting on her decision, she fondly recalls, "The mindset of the owner—giving you the freedom to operate, irrespective of the geography... those are some of the qualities that I felt unique."

Since then, Varma's trajectory within Amazon has been remarkable. Initially managing technology teams, she now serves as the Vice President of Human Resources, overseeing corporate and Amazon Stores across APAC,

Japan, Middle East, Africa, and the Emerging Markets. Simultaneously, Amazon itself has evolved into a colossal entity spanning e-commerce, media, entertainment, and cloud computing. From humble beginnings occupying just one floor, Amazon in India now commands millions of square feet across hundreds of locations and boasts a workforce exceeding 100,000 employees.

But growth is always accompanied by challenges, particularly when it comes to managing diverse teams operating in disparate industries and environments. At Amazon India—which is at No. 8 on *BT-Tagg*'s The Best Companies to Work For in India list this year—what keeps the ball rolling is the company's approach towards such challenges. As Varma puts it, the solution has to be simple, scaleable, and intuitive. Take its primary HR portal, MyHR, for instance. It is a one-stop solution for all employee-related inquiries, with a comprehensive suite of features, and helps to seamlessly navigate through personalised profiles, check shift schedules, and request time off, all of which is done without any hassle.

And there are others. In an age when mental health issues are increasingly becoming acute, Amazon's Twill comes in handy. An



8 AMAZON INDIA TOP ATTRIBUTES

- GROWTH AND LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES
- JOB SECURITY AND STABILITY
- WORKLOAD AND FLEXIBILITY AT WORK

◀ **EMPATHETIC LEADER** Deepti Varma, Vice President, HR/People eXperience and Technology, Amazon Stores India & Emerging Markets